

Room types in repo: duo, friends, family

Session modes in repo: watch, music, podcast, reading, study

WHAT IT IS

A synchronized shared-media app for private rooms.

Users can watch, listen, co-read PDFs, or run study sessions while chatting live.

WHO IT IS FOR

Primary persona: a signed-in host inviting a partner, friend, family member, or small group into a shared room for media plus social interaction.

WHAT IT DOES

- Private room types for couple, friend, and family sessions.
- Five modes: watch, music, podcast, co-reading, and study.
- Playback or page sync across participants.
- Live chat, emoji reactions, bookmarks, and host-aware controls.
- WebRTC voice/video call signaling inside rooms.
- Social layer with friends, notifications, memories, insights, and couple watchlists.

HOW IT WORKS

- React + Vite frontend boots App, DashboardView, and per-mode session engines.
- Firebase Auth signs users in; the frontend sends ID tokens in REST and Socket.IO auth.
- Express REST + Socket.IO verify tokens with Firebase Admin and power rooms, sync, chat, reactions, invites, temporary PDF sharing, and WebRTC signaling.
- MongoDB via Mongoose stores profiles, relationships, rooms, sessions, reactions, milestones, and yearly insights; the server falls back to in-memory data if Mongo is absent.
- Active room state, sync clocks, presence, and expiring document uploads also live in memory.

HOW TO RUN

1. Install dependencies in the repo root, backend, and frontend.
2. Provide Firebase Admin credentials with FIREBASE_SERVICE_ACCOUNT or FIREBASE_SERVICE_ACCOUNT_PATH. Set MONGODB_URI if you want persistence.
3. From the repo root, run npm start.
4. Defaults in code: backend port 5001, frontend Vite port 5173, and VITE_SERVER_URL can override the frontend-to-backend target.

NOT FOUND IN REPO

- Top-level setup README.
- Deployment or production runbook.

KEY EVIDENCE

package.json, backend/server.js, backend/DB_ARCHITECTURE.md, frontend/src/App.jsx, frontend/src/DashboardView.jsx, frontend/src/firebase.js, frontend/src/engines/*, and frontend/vite.config.js